co-sponsors from five other parties, four of which were members of the coalition: Yesh Atid, Jewish Home, HaTnuah, and Yisrael Beiteinu. The legislation was one of the few issues to attract truly cross-partisan support.

Both *Israel HaYom* and the prime minister's office deny that there is any collusion over coverage. But in its most egregious moments, the paper really does live up to the *Pravda* comparisons. On the Saturday before the election, Netanyahu and his top challenger, Isaac Herzog, faced off for a "mini-debate" on Channel 2. Herzog was in the studio, while the prime minister spoke from his residence, looming over Herzog on a giant screen.

That Sunday's *Israel HaYom* featured a photo of the debate on page three, with an accusatory red circle around the earpiece clipped to Herzog's collar. "Herzog was the only interviewee with a headset," it noted matter-of-factly, implying that someone—perhaps his campaign staff, perhaps a Channel 2 producer—was feeding him material from backstage. The incriminating "headset", of course, was the IFB earpiece that any television guest wears. Herzog couldn't hear Netanyahu without one. The prime minister surely had one of his own. But Herzog had a reputation for being indecisive and clueless. *Israel HaYom* found a way to reinforce it, to hundreds of thousands of readers, just two days before the ballot.

His finger on the button

Benjamin Netanyahu was a busy man in his fourth government. In addition to his day job as prime minister, he also served as communications minister, foreign affairs minister, economy minister, and the "minister of regional cooperation." (He briefly added the defense portfolio to that list during the interregnum between Ya'alon's resignation and Lieberman's appointment.)

He took most of those jobs in order to hold them in reserve for a potential center-left coalition partner. The foreign ministry, in particular, was seen as a lure for Isaac Herzog, a way to entice him into a unity government. But one of them was sacrosanct. During his talks with Herzog, the Labor leader asked Netanyahu to give his party the communications ministry. "I'd give you the prime minister's job before that," Netanyahu reportedly replied. With two newspapers already in hand, he wanted to use the ministry to rein in Israel's broadcast and online media.

Israel is a tiny media market, smaller than even the population of 8.4 million would suggest. One-fifth of Israeli citizens are Arabs, who speak